LITERATURE REVIEW / RESEARCH DOSSIER

The Hidden Costs of Book Identification

A source-by-source review for the Portugal 2015 ISBN-fee study

23 individually reviewed papers, institutional sources, and primary policy documents

Organized around fixed participation costs, independent publishing and author services, platform dependence, discoverability, bibliographic statistics, eligibility rules, and legal deposit.

Prepared 9 November 2026 • Working literature review

Reading principle: Every source is summarized separately. Each entry distinguishes what its evidence supports from what the Portuguese study would need to establish independently. A citation link is embedded in each source page.

Evidence status: peer-reviewed research, professional reports, journalism, commercial statements and official rules are clearly differentiated. The two previously drafted reviews have been consolidated; time-specific points were checked against source pages where accessible.

Guide to the dossier

Read scholarly research for mechanisms, industry reports for documented contract risks, and official rules for specific institutional examples. None independently establishes that the 2015 Portuguese ISBN fee caused all proposed downstream harms.

01 **Monetizing Platforms: An Empirical Analysis of Supply and Demand Responses to Entry Costs in Two-Sided Markets** (2025)
02 **The Self-Publishing Phenomenon and Libraries** (2006)
03 **Missing the Point: The Disappointed Hope of Self-Publishing Authors** (2023)
04 **Non-traditional Book Publishing** (2011)
05 **Consumer Surplus in the Digital Economy: Estimating the Value of Increased Product Variety at Online Booksellers** (2003)
06 **Self-Publishing: A New Challenge for Universal Bibliographic Control** (2014)

07 **Is It a Steal? An Investigation into Hybrid / Paid-for Publishing Services** (2022)
08 **Livros: Quanto Custa e Como se Publica em Portugal** (2017)
09 **Quanto Custa Publicar um Livro em Portugal** (2026)
10 **Perguntas Frequentes / Autopublicação** (2026)

11 **Get an ISBN** (2026)
12 **Expanded Distribution** (2026)
13 **KDP Select / Digital Exclusivity** (2026)
14 **Paperback Printing Costs and Royalty Economics** (2026)

15 **Regulamento de Prémios** (2026)
16 **Regulamento de Apoio às Editoras e Livrarias** (2020)
17 **Edital n.º 822/2025: Academic Hiring Scoring Criteria** (2025)
18 **Tablero Registros ISBN / Regional ISBN Statistics** (2026)
19 **CIP Program: Eligibility and Membership** (2026)

20 **Decreto-Lei n.º 74/82: Depósito Legal** (1982)
21 **Definitions: National Bibliography and Bibliographic Control** (2026)
22 **What Is an ISBN?** (2026)
23 **APEL Circular: ISBN 2015 - Novas Regras** (2014)

A short synthesis and empirical-testing roadmap follow all source reviews.

ACADEMIC RESEARCH / SOURCE 01

Monetizing Platforms: An Empirical Analysis of Supply and Demand Responses to Entry Costs in Two-Sided Markets

Kai Zhu, Qiaoni Shi & Shrabastee Banerjee · 2025
Peer-reviewed journal article | Management Science

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

What happens to small creators, publisher concentration and the variety of books presented to readers when Goodreads begins charging for a formerly free promotional channel?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Natural experiment: Goodreads Giveaways imposed a $119 basic campaign charge on 9 January 2018. The article analyzes 101,684 giveaways for 82,552 books, roughly 36 million associated ratings, and publisher-level comparisons across a historical placebo period and the treated period. It estimates fixed-effect differences and measures publisher concentration and genre diversity.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Participation dropped disproportionately for independent and self-publishing service publishers; the Big Five gained share. The average campaign-level publisher HHI rose from about 0.01 to 0.03. Shannon genre entropy declined; niche genres lost about 26% of their relative representation, while popular genres gained about 11%. These outcomes concern books promoted on Goodreads, not all books in existence.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Best causal analogue for a fixed-cost barrier affecting creator visibility. Replicate heterogeneity by pre-fee publisher size and compute HHI and Shannon entropy for ISBN-bearing versus complete legal-deposit Portuguese publishing. Explain why market participation can change without a proportional decline in underlying creation.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

A promotion fee is not an ISBN fee. The design relies on observational policy timing and comparison assumptions. Never claim this article demonstrates lower Portugal book production or proves ISBN avoidance.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Pre-specify genres using pre-2015 Portuguese classification, then estimate changes in registered-catalogue diversity relative to complete legal deposit.

Source: doi.org/10.1287/mnsc.2023.01390

ACADEMIC RESEARCH / SOURCE 02

The Self-Publishing Phenomenon and Libraries

Juris Dilevko & Keren Dali · 2006
Peer-reviewed journal article | Library & Information Science Research 28:208-234

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

How extensively do North American public and academic libraries collect self-published and author-services books?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

WorldCat/OCLC-based bibliographic holdings study of seven US self-publishing and subsidy/author-service firms, concentrating on their 2000-2004 output. The universe of all books printed by these firms is not observed; the analysis focuses on titles with records in member libraries.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Among 14,061 catalogued titles from the studied firms, 42.8% were held in a single OCLC-member library and 93.4% in fewer than ten. The article discusses discovery, reviews, approval plans, vendor discounts, reputation and marketing as potential mechanisms behind limited holdings.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Establishes that self-published works can face low institutional penetration even when they have reached a bibliographic system. Strong rationale to measure a book-level external-catalogue match or number of holdings for Portugal.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Does not compare books with and without ISBNs, or establish that missing identifiers cause low library holdings. Historic US book-market context differs from Portugal 2015.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Use Portuguese legal-deposit books as the denominator and match both ISBN and no-ISBN books to other libraries by normalized author and title, not by ISBN.

Source: doi.org/10.1016/j.lisr.2006.03.003

ACADEMIC RESEARCH / SOURCE 03

Missing the Point: The Disappointed Hope of Self-Publishing Authors

Simone Schroff · 2023
Peer-reviewed journal article | International Journal of Cultural Policy, online 2023 / vol. 30 (2024)

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

Why does direct self-publishing not necessarily deliver better bargaining power or incomes for authors after traditional publishers are bypassed?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Institutional and network analysis of UK trade publishing, drawing on distribution relationships, industry practices, contractual organization and network centrality. The author frames self-publishing as one route through concentrated bookselling and distribution infrastructure.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Self-published authors retain significant responsibilities for production and promotion, while remaining dependent on intermediaries for reach. The paper argues that bargaining power and information asymmetries persist; online platforms may lower entry costs but also govern access and terms.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Supplies a rigorous conceptual foundation for platform dependence, switching costs, and distribution trade-offs. Cite alongside Amazon KDP policies; explain why a free platform-issued ISBN might not be economically identical to an independently registered one.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Not a causal estimate of Amazon effects on income, nor evidence of Portuguese authors switching because of the 2015 fee. It should not be paraphrased as proof that Amazon exploits every author.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Measure use of recognizable platform-issued ISBNs, imprint concentration, and changes in publisher choice over time; assess launch and coverage timing carefully.

Source: doi.org/10.1080/10286632.2023.2288584

ACADEMIC RESEARCH / SOURCE 04

Non-traditional Book Publishing

Jana Bradley, Bruce Fulton, Marlene Helm & Katherine A. Pittner · 2011
Scholarly journal article | First Monday 16(8)

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

How does the explosion of nontraditional production change the meaning of published-book counts and bibliographic discovery?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Overview of nontraditional and self-publishing markets with empirical sampling of titles, study of bibliographic characteristics, and discussion of US ISBN-based industry statistics. The nontraditional category covers public-domain reprints as well as original author-published books.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

The authors argue that conventional ISBN-focused counts miss some output, especially books lacking standard identifiers and metadata. They emphasize heterogeneous content, ambiguous editions, and the inadequacy of traditional discovery systems for a rapidly expanding supply of titles.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

The closest conceptual foundation for your statistical-measurement argument: production, identifier adoption and catalogued visibility are different constructs. Useful for explaining why an ISBN-registration trend should not automatically be called a trend in book creation.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

The figures and market structure are historically specific, and reprints must not be described as new original authorship. The study is descriptive, not causal evidence about Portuguese fees.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Decompose Portuguese trends into deposited titles, registered ISBNs and books matched to outside discovery catalogues, showing their different numerators and denominators.

Source: doi.org/10.5210/fm.v16i8.3353

ACADEMIC RESEARCH / SOURCE 05

Consumer Surplus in the Digital Economy: Estimating the Value of Increased Product Variety at Online Booksellers

Erik Brynjolfsson, Yu (Jeffrey) Hu & Michael D. Smith · 2003
Peer-reviewed journal article | Management Science 49(11)

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

Why can a long tail of low-demand books still matter for consumer welfare?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Economic demand estimation comparing the broader product variety available through online booksellers with conventional physical stores. Builds a consumer-surplus framework for expanded product choice.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

The paper estimates sizeable historical consumer benefits from online assortment depth (the widely reported range is approximately $731 million-$1.03 billion in 2000). Crucially, even books with small individual audiences can contribute collectively to welfare because reader tastes differ.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Provides the welfare intuition for concern about specialist, local-history and niche titles: absence from discovery systems may matter even when each individual work has limited sales.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

The estimate is about online book variety around 2000, not about ISBN fees, Portuguese libraries or Amazon contracts today. Do not transfer the numerical welfare figure to Portugal.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Test whether the registered subset of Portuguese deposited works became less representative of niche subjects after 2015; avoid monetizing losses without a demand model.

Source: doi.org/10.1287/mnsc.49.11.1580.20580

ACADEMIC / CONFERENCE / SOURCE 06

Self-Publishing: A New Challenge for Universal Bibliographic Control

Robert P. Holley · 2014
IFLA conference paper | 80th World Library and Information Congress

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

How can national bibliographic systems cope with self-published books outside conventional review, vendor and cataloguing channels?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Professional scholarly synthesis drawing on US cataloguing institutions, library supply chains, reviewing practices and changing self-publishing volumes.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Holley identifies missing or inconsistent bibliographic control as a separate problem from whether a book exists. Traditional review and wholesaler workflows may overlook self-published titles; local-library collections and shared catalogues offer partial alternatives.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Excellent reference when distinguishing national ISBN registry records from legal deposit, the full national bibliography, retail discovery and global library holdings.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Conference synthesis, not a causal study. Does not demonstrate that a Portuguese book without an ISBN was lost to national preservation.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Create a catalogue-overlap matrix for Portugal: national legal deposit, national ISBN records, Google Books, Open Library and foreign libraries.

Source: digitalcommons.wayne.edu/slisfrp/124/

INDUSTRY INVESTIGATION / SOURCE 07

Is It a Steal? An Investigation into Hybrid / Paid-for Publishing Services

Society of Authors & Writers' Guild of Great Britain · 2022
Investigative report | UK writers' organizations

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

What financial outcomes and contract experiences do writers report after using publishers that charge them while taking publishing rights?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Online voluntary survey of 240 responding writers, conducted in 2021, plus contract/marketing analysis. Among responders reporting deal economics, the reported UK median initial payment was GBP 2,000; separate subsets reported royalties, profits and losses.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

The report gives median sales of 67 books, median UK royalties of GBP 68, a UK median reported loss of GBP 1,861, and 59% reporting no retail availability. Of 65 respondents reporting a profit/loss outcome, 61 reported a loss and four a profit. This 61/65 denominator is important.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Documents a plausible risk from author-financed intermediary substitution: higher upfront costs, uncertain distribution, rights restrictions and opaque marketing claims. Use as a UK risk illustration, not as Portuguese prevalence.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Self-selected respondents, small item-specific sample sizes and potential negative-experience selection. The 94% is not the loss rate among all hybrid authors. The report itself is an advocacy investigation, not a randomized comparison.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

For Portuguese service imprints, classify actual contracts and services rather than calling every author-services brand a vanity publisher; collect dated historical prices.

Source: writersguild.org.uk/wp-content/uploads/2022/05/REPORT-Is-it-a-steal.pdf

PORTUGUESE MARKET SOURCE / SOURCE 08

Livros: Quanto Custa e Como se Publica em Portugal

ECO (Portuguese business journalism) · 2017
Contemporaneous market reporting | Portugal

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

What practical publishing models and economic arrangements existed in Portugal shortly after the 2015 ISBN reform?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Portuguese business-reporting interviews and industry discussion of conventional, self-financed and hybrid publishing, including accounts of Chiado Editora and other firms.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Confirms that author-funded publishing was a recognized model in the relevant market and documents disputes about who bears financial risk, who pays and the visibility offered to authors.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Provides period-appropriate Portuguese institutional context, which is more relevant to the 2015 reform than only contemporary KDP pages or UK studies.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Journalism relies on interviewees and reported business practices. Do not interpret it as systematic evidence that a specific firm harmed authors or that fees pushed authors into its model.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Use contemporaneous publisher names to establish an auditable time-varying service-imprint list; validate historical classification against archived offerings.

Source: eco.sapo.pt/reportagem/livros-quanto-custa-e-como-se-publica-em-portugal/

PORTUGUESE MARKET SOURCE / SOURCE 09

Quanto Custa Publicar um Livro em Portugal

Cordel D'Prata · 2026
Publisher-owned marketing / price disclosure | Portugal

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

What costs and service bundles does a present-day Portuguese publisher advertise for independent authors?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

The publisher's own 12 October 2026 guide explains editorial, design, ISBN, legal deposit, printing, distribution and promotion services. It advertises some author-contribution proposals beginning at EUR 790 and also says it funds selected projects itself.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Documents the existence of substantial author payments in some Portuguese publishing-service offerings. This is evidence of current available contract structures, not a marketwide price or the firm's historic pricing.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

A concrete, primary quote for what author-service packages may bundle beyond an ISBN. Helps avoid the mistaken implication that a EUR 15 ISBN fee alone explains a EUR 790+ package purchase.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Commercial promotional source, dated 2026; no inference about 2015 prices or typical royalties is justified. Independently verify any rights and distribution claims before describing outcomes.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Build a historical price dataset with archived offers and distinguish required service costs from optional design/printing services.

Source: cordeldeprata.pt/guias/quanto-custa-publicar-um-livro/

PORTUGUESE MARKET SOURCE / SOURCE 10

Perguntas Frequentes / Autopublicação

Chiado Books · 2026
Publisher FAQ and platform disclosure | Portugal

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

What does a Portuguese publishing intermediary currently claim about rights, traditional publication and self-publishing arrangements?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

First-party FAQ and linked self-publishing pages describing its models and client services.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

The provider distinguishes conventional publishing and self-publishing and advertises a free self-publishing route. It is a counterexample to treating every platform, author-service firm or hybrid model as necessarily paid or exploitative.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Use to define transparent categories: traditional acquisition, fee-based services, author-run self-publishing, and fee-free platform services. Avoid pooling them indiscriminately.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Current marketing statements are not historical contract data and do not verify outcomes for individual authors. The page is not peer-reviewed evidence of welfare.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Code individual provider-year offers by fee, rights, minimum sales/print terms, and whether the provider or author controls the imprint.

Source: www.chiadobooks.com/faq-s

PLATFORM TERMS / SOURCE 11

Get an ISBN

Amazon Kindle Direct Publishing · 2026
Primary platform policy | current KDP Help

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

What autonomy is gained or lost when an author uses a free ISBN issued through Amazon rather than independently registering one?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Amazon's official comparison table states that a free KDP ISBN is usable only with KDP and registers the imprint as “Independently published” with Bowker; an author-owned ISBN can be used outside KDP, subject to edition/metadata rules.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Free ISBNs remove immediate payment but limit reuse of that identifier with competing publishing services. The book may still have a valid ISBN, registered with Bowker. The author does not thereby lose copyright ownership.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Provides primary evidence for identifier portability and platform-branding trade-offs. Prefer language like switching costs and restricted identifier reuse rather than unqualified exploitation.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Current terms do not prove that the same conditions existed in 2015; platform launch/format conditions need archival verification. A Bowker-issued ISBN is not absent from the global ISBN system.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Estimate foreign/platform prefix prevalence in Portuguese books by year and isolate editions where the same author later switches imprint/identifier.

Source: kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/GTJ8LBXL6Z4WV5QX

PLATFORM TERMS / SOURCE 12

Expanded Distribution

Amazon Kindle Direct Publishing · 2026
Primary platform policy | current KDP Help

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

Does Amazon's expanded distribution guarantee bookstore/library access, and what costs accompany it?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Platform terms describing distributor availability, eligibility criteria, and royalty calculation. Booksellers and libraries may discover titles through partner distributors but need not order or stock them.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

For eligible paperbacks, Expanded Distribution generally pays 40% of the relevant list price less printing costs and applicable amounts; enrollment is not a guarantee of downstream stocking or library purchases.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Illustrates that digital/platform distribution does not equal library acquisition. Useful to describe contractual access and payment terms with a primary source.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

No inference that a national ISBN would guarantee a physical bookstore sale either. Current royalty rates should not be treated as historic 2015 terms.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

If data permit, compare actual multi-retailer holdings or price/royalty distribution across imprint types; otherwise retain as institutional background.

Source: kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/GQTT4W3T5AYK7L45

PLATFORM TERMS / SOURCE 13

KDP Select / Digital Exclusivity

Amazon Kindle Direct Publishing · 2026
Primary platform policy | current KDP Help

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

What exclusivity trade-off is associated with certain Amazon ebook promotion programs?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Amazon help and contractual material describe optional KDP Select enrollment, including ebook exclusivity over a defined enrollment period in exchange for program benefits.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Illustrates a potential promotional trade-off available to an author who relies on a platform. This is distinct from the free ISBN offered for eligible print editions.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Use only as a separate example of platform incentives and business-model dependence, not as a direct restriction imposed by a paperback ISBN.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Enrollment terms can change; eligibility and exceptions need checking against relevant date. Do not state that free ISBNs automatically entail ebook exclusivity.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Track program participation only if independently observed; otherwise cite narratively as an optional contract choice.

Source: kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G200798990

PLATFORM TERMS / SOURCE 14

Paperback Printing Costs and Royalty Economics

Amazon Kindle Direct Publishing · 2026
Primary platform terms | current KDP Help

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

How do authors' net receipts differ from headline royalty percentages when using a print-on-demand platform?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Official printing-cost calculations specify how trim size, paper, ink, page count and marketplace affect the cost subtracted from royalties. Expanded Distribution has separate rates.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Published royalty rates do not equal profit: printing and other deductions matter, as do editing, cover design and marketing outlays outside the platform.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Use to define author net-revenue components in a conceptual model and explain why a free ISBN is only one dimension of the total publishing cost.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Without observed quantities and author costs, do not infer actual losses or that KDP yields lower earnings than every alternative.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Illustrative calibration only: compare expected author net proceeds across routes using explicit, dated assumptions.

Source: kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G201834340

INSTITUTIONAL RULE / SOURCE 15

Regulamento de Prémios

P.E.N. Clube Português · 2026
Primary institutional regulation | literary prizes

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

Do Portuguese literary prize rules make ISBN registration an explicit condition?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Prize regulation states that the annual call can accept printed or electronic formats, with ISBN registration mandatory. Categories include poetry, essay, narrative and translation.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

An otherwise existing work without a valid ISBN may be excluded by a formal recognition rule under the published regulation.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Concrete, non-speculative illustration that identifier participation can affect access to literary recognition. The presence of a formal rule is established, not the number of excluded writers.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Present page is not documented as the 2015 text. Prize rules and eligibility may vary by year and award; verify historic editions if estimating an effect.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Collect annual entrants and rejected-application reasons, if accessible, before claiming an actual fee-induced loss of prize opportunities.

Source: penportugal.pt/regulamento-premios/

INSTITUTIONAL RULE / SOURCE 16

Regulamento de Apoio às Editoras e Livrarias

Direção-Geral do Livro, dos Arquivos e das Bibliotecas (DGLAB) · 2020
Primary government support notice | Portugal

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

Do actual public-sector funding application forms use ISBNs to describe eligible books?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

2020 Portuguese public support notice lists an editable Excel submission of works proposed for support and asks for title, author, ISBN, edition date, list price and quantity.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

ISBNs directly enter administrative information supplied when requesting aid. This is a verifiable mechanism connecting registration to government programs.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Best concrete example of a policy process that collects ISBN-based information. Show the actual form fields; do not hypothesize altered funding allocations without data.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

A requested ISBN field is not automatically proof that no-ISBN books were formally ineligible. The regulation was pandemic-era support, not a 2015 ISBN policy.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Review rejected/accepted applications, if available, to distinguish missing-data requirements from exclusionary eligibility thresholds.

Source: dglab.gov.pt/regulamento-apoio-editoras-e-livrarias/

INSTITUTIONAL RULE / SOURCE 17

Edital n.º 822/2025: Academic Hiring Scoring Criteria

Instituto Politécnico de Beja · 2025
Official public recruitment notice | Diário da República

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

Can formal academic evaluation schemes award different credit to books with an ISBN?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

2025 hiring notice has explicit points for national/international books and book chapters identified with ISBNs, within technical-scientific selection criteria.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Shows a real professional-evaluation rule that makes ISBN status salient in determining the scoring of specified publication types.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Cite to show institutional reliance on ISBN-linked outputs beyond bookshops and marketing. Useful in a narrowly framed implications subsection.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

This is one specific institution and recruitment competition. The notice does not establish the treatment of no-ISBN work in every case or any realized career effect of ISBN fees.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

If pursuing consequence estimation, collect criteria across a systematic sample of Portuguese public calls, not one illustrative notice.

Source: diariodarepublica.pt/dr/detalhe/edital/822-2025-916787682

INSTITUTIONAL DATA / SOURCE 18

Tablero Registros ISBN / Regional ISBN Statistics

CERLALC · 2026
Official regional data dashboard | UNESCO-associated regional center

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

How are national ISBN agency registrations used to compare publishing output and classify publisher types across countries?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

CERLALC publishes counts and descriptive breakdowns supplied by national ISBN agencies, including author-publishers. The dashboard explicitly distinguishes ISBN registrations from unique titles; editions and formats can have different ISBNs.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Demonstrates a real descriptive data product conditioned on identifier registration. An increase or decrease in registration can alter these counts even without proportional changes in books created.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Main documented evidence for measurement vulnerability and cross-country comparison. Use author-publisher registrations as the specific outcome; preserve comparability and year definitions.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

This is not proof that a particular policy decision was wrong because of these statistics. Prices, multi-format editions, agency coverage and self-publisher definitions differ.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Cross-country exploratory scatterplot: PPP-adjusted one-ISBN fees versus agency author-publisher share, with error and missing-country notes; do not give causal interpretation.

Source: cerlalc.org/tablero-registros-isbn/

INSTITUTIONAL RULE / SOURCE 19

CIP Program: Eligibility and Membership

Library of Congress · 2026
Official US library policy | Cataloging in Publication

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

Are self-published and author-financed books eligible for the US Library of Congress Cataloging in Publication program?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Official CIP eligibility rules identify author-paid or subsidized books among ineligible categories. The Library also directs ineligible self-publishers toward the separate Preassigned Control Number (PCN) program.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

CIP is a particular prepublication cataloguing program; its exclusions illustrate formal differentiation between commercial-publisher workflows and self-published titles.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Use as a concrete bibliographic-access restriction affecting self-publishers. Explain why those restrictions operate independently of whether a book has an ISBN.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

CIP exclusion does not imply that all self-published books are missing from the Library of Congress collection or national records; PCN exists, and ISBNs do not determine copyright.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Compare the overlaps of different programs and catalogs separately: CIP, PCN/LCCN, holdings, commercial ISBN registration, national deposit.

Source: www.loc.gov/programs/cataloging-in-publication/eligibility/

Decreto-Lei n.º 74/82: Depósito Legal

Portuguese Republic · 1982
Primary Portuguese legislation | legal deposit

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

What does Portuguese law require for legal deposit, and does preservation depend on buying an ISBN?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Articles 1-3 define mandatory deposit of publications and objectives including preservation of Portuguese-language/cultural values, maintenance of a national collection, bibliography production and national publishing statistics.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Legal deposit is institutionally separate from ISBN assignment. A book can be deposited without a commercial ISBN; absence of an ISBN is not equivalent to falling into the public domain or being impossible to preserve.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Central methodological reason to use the legal-deposit bibliography as a benchmark against national ISBN agency registrations. It allows comparison of production proxies and identification rates.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

The legal duty is not evidence of perfect compliance. Deposit coverage may be uneven and may change over time; cataloguing shifts can mimic policy effects.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Estimate ISBN presence among deposited books within a stable bibliographic coding system; cross-check catalogue practice changes around 2014.

Source: diariodarepublica.pt/dr/detalhe/decreto-lei/74-1982-599921

INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK / SOURCE 21

Definitions: National Bibliography and Bibliographic Control

International Federation of Library Associations (IFLA) · 2026
Professional standards / definitions

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

What is a national bibliography and what does bibliographic control aim to accomplish?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

Professional definitions describe national bibliography as an authoritative record of a nation's publishing output, often linked to legal deposit, national-library responsibilities and standardized description.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

Supports the distinction between a public bibliography, ISBN registry, wholesaler catalog and global discovery system. These are overlapping but nonidentical measurement universes.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Use early in the literature review to define the outcome categories and explain why undercounting in one system is not necessarily a failure of legal deposit.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

The page is a definitional framework, not empirical evidence of missing books or harm. National implementation varies.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Create precise data provenance table: what each database includes/excludes and its unit of record.

Source: www.ifla.org/g/bibliography/definitions/

INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK / SOURCE 22

What Is an ISBN?

International ISBN Agency · 2026
Authoritative industry standard explainer

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

What exactly does an ISBN identify, and what legal status does it provide?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

The agency explains the five ISBN components, edition/format distinctions, product ordering/stock-control uses, publisher registrant identification, and the role of national agencies.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

An ISBN is a book-product identifier used in supply chains; it is not copyright registration, not a guarantee of library deposit, and does not convey intellectual-property rights.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Use to avoid causal and legal confusion: an author lacking an ISBN can still own copyright and publish, but may face administrative and supply-chain frictions.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Definitions establish potential uses, not an estimate of how much missing ISBNs reduce sales. A valid foreign-issued ISBN remains an ISBN.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Define each outcome: registration, ISBN-bearing book, unique title, edition, bibliographic record, library holding, and physical copy.

Source: www.isbn-international.org/content/what-isbn/10

POLICY PRIMARY SOURCE / SOURCE 23

APEL Circular: ISBN 2015 - Novas Regras

Associação Portuguesa de Editores e Livreiros (APEL) · 2014
Portuguese ISBN agency notice | 11 December 2014

RESEARCH QUESTION / RELEVANCE

Exactly what changed in the Portuguese ISBN system at the start of 2015?

EVIDENCE, DATA AND APPROACH

The contemporaneous circular provided by the researcher says the Portuguese state subsidy ended on 31 December 2014, prompting new fees on 1 January 2015. It lists EUR 15 for individual author editions (nonprofessional), multiple prefix-block rates, digital-only request forms and continued validity of existing publisher prefixes.

PRINCIPAL FINDING(S)

This is indispensable institutional evidence: it pins down the date, schedules, affected applicant categories and a simultaneous electronic-workflow change. Previously issued prefixes remained valid until exhausted.

HOW TO USE THIS IN THE PORTUGAL PAPER

Place at the center of the policy background and identification discussion, and separate the price shock from online-submission change. The letter is a contemporaneous announcement, not a later retrospective narrative.

LIMITS: WHAT THE SOURCE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

The document does not contain daily application counts, complete assignment dates, actual payments by registrant or a clean universal serial-number cutoff.

SUGGESTED ORIGINAL EMPIRICAL TEST

Explore fee exposure determined by exhausted versus unexhausted prefix stocks; test whether the 2014 announcement triggered anticipatory registrations.

Source: web.archive.org/web/20150203073522/http://apel.pt/pageview.aspx?pageid=875&langid=1

Synthesis / How the sources fit together

The research claim has four distinct levels. The literature supports the existence of several mechanisms; the Portugal study must provide the evidence linking them.

1 Participation cost

APEL documents the 2015 tariff. Zhu et al. show in a different market that new fixed fees disproportionately affected smaller publishers. Your within-Portugal DiD and synthetic-control work test differential exposure, but cannot yet isolate the fee from the simultaneous online reform.

2 Route substitution

Authors may forgo a national identifier, purchase services from an intermediary or use a platform-issued ISBN. SoA/WGGB documents risks of certain paid contracts; Schroff explains dependence and bargaining power; KDP documents identifier portability. None independently shows a 2015 Portugal migration among these routes.

3 Measured visibility

Bradley et al., Holley and IFLA explain why the universe of published works and catalogued ISBN titles differ. Dilevko and Dali show limited library holdings among catalogued self-published books. The project should quantify author-title matching and ISBN presence in separate systems rather than assuming record absence.

4 Consequences / institutions

PEN Portugal requires an ISBN in its prize regulation; DGLAB requests ISBN fields for certain support applications; a 2025 Beja hiring notice scores books with ISBNs. These are documented institutional uses, not evidence that a specific Portuguese author's award or income changed as a result of the ISBN fee.

Proposed hierarchy of claims

Documented: Portugal changed fees and application procedures; particular institutions use ISBN identifiers; KDP-issued identifiers have platform restrictions.
Associated: preliminary Portuguese post-2015 relative reductions in ISBN-bearing author-published records; exploratory Google Books visibility differences.
Not yet identified: fee-only causal effect; number of authors switching to Amazon or paid services because of fees; welfare loss or specific policy decisions caused by miscounting.

Econometric extensions: prioritized tests

Use these as a methods workplan, not as completed results.

A. Book-level discoverability regression

Outcome = match in independent external catalogue (0/1), or number of independent library holdings. Key predictor = missing ISBN. Control for publication year, field/genre, language, length, author history and publisher type. Match **both** groups by normalized title and author rather than ISBN. Report adjusted associations, selection caveats and manual-match precision.

B. Publisher-route event study

Construct service-imprint counts by year using a verified historical list. Outcomes: service books / all deposited books and service books / ISBN-bearing books. Estimate post-2015 breaks only after plotting prior trends and genre mix. A changing denominator can produce a spurious increase in shares.

C. Catalogue-representativeness index

Calculate the distribution of genres among all deposited self-published books and among ISBN-bearing ones. Compute Shannon entropy, HHI and total-variation distance. Compare gaps over time and test placebo reform years. Pre-specify genres to avoid choosing categories ex post.

D. ISBN fee vs author-publisher share across countries

Use CERLALC agency counts and audited historical prices, PPP-adjusted to a common year. Show scatterplot and robust regression as **descriptive**, with country-year labels, missingness, internet penetration and income controls only as sensitivity checks; do not interpret as policy causation.

E. Platform-identifier substitution

Track identifiable US/foreign Amazon publisher prefixes and imprints among Portuguese deposited titles. Test different rollout dates and use both legal-deposit and platform catalogues; 979-8 is mainly informative for later years, not by itself the immediate 2015 reform.

Critical distinction

A valid foreign-issued ISBN is still an ISBN. Missing from a national agency count does not imply missing from legal deposit, the national bibliography, the Library of Congress, copyright protection, or the public domain. Keep each database's universe explicit.

Reference guide and source audit

All links below are live references; source-specific details and methodological cautions are on the corresponding individual pages.

01. Kai Zhu, Qiaoni Shi & Shrabastee Banerjee (2025). *Monetizing Platforms: An Empirical Analysis of Supply and Demand Responses to Entry Costs in Two-Sided Markets*. Source link.

02. Juris Dilevko & Keren Dali (2006). *The Self-Publishing Phenomenon and Libraries*. Source link.

03. Simone Schroff (2023). *Missing the Point: The Disappointed Hope of Self-Publishing Authors*. Source link.

04. Jana Bradley, Bruce Fulton, Marlene Helm & Katherine A. Pittner (2011). *Non-traditional Book Publishing*. Source link.

05. Erik Brynjolfsson, Yu (Jeffrey) Hu & Michael D. Smith (2003). *Consumer Surplus in the Digital Economy: Estimating the Value of Increased Product Variety at Online Booksellers*. Source link.

06. Robert P. Holley (2014). *Self-Publishing: A New Challenge for Universal Bibliographic Control*. Source link.

07. Society of Authors & Writers' Guild of Great Britain (2022). *Is It a Steal? An Investigation into Hybrid / Paid-for Publishing Services*. Source link.

08. ECO (Portuguese business journalism) (2017). *Livros: Quanto Custa e Como se Publica em Portugal*. Source link.

09. Cordel D'Prata (2026). *Quanto Custa Publicar um Livro em Portugal*. Source link.

10. Chiado Books (2026). *Perguntas Frequentes / Autopublicação*. Source link.

11. Amazon Kindle Direct Publishing (2026). *Get an ISBN*. Source link.

12. Amazon Kindle Direct Publishing (2026). *Expanded Distribution*. Source link.

13. Amazon Kindle Direct Publishing (2026). *KDP Select / Digital Exclusivity*. Source link.

14. Amazon Kindle Direct Publishing (2026). *Paperback Printing Costs and Royalty Economics*. Source link.

15. P.E.N. Clube Português (2026). *Regulamento de Prémios*. Source link.

16. Direção-Geral do Livro, dos Arquivos e das Bibliotecas (DGLAB) (2020). *Regulamento de Apoio às Editoras e Livrarias*. Source link.

17. Instituto Politécnico de Beja (2025). *Edital n.º 822/2025: Academic Hiring Scoring Criteria*. Source link.

18. CERLALC (2026). *Tablero Registros ISBN / Regional ISBN Statistics*. Source link.

19. Library of Congress (2026). *CIP Program: Eligibility and Membership*. Source link.

20. Portuguese Republic (1982). *Decreto-Lei n.º 74/82: Depósito Legal*. Source link.

21. International Federation of Library Associations (IFLA) (2026). *Definitions: National Bibliography and Bibliographic Control*. Source link.

22. International ISBN Agency (2026). *What Is an ISBN?*. Source link.

23. Associação Portuguesa de Editores e Livreiros (APEL) (2014). *APEL Circular: ISBN 2015 - Novas Regras*. Source link.

Editorial checks before journal submission

Verify historical terms against archived 2014-2019 pages; obtain dated primary sources for all fee-price series; conduct independent human validation of author-publisher classifications; audit the matching denominator for external catalogues; and report null and negative results alongside findings. Current platform policies and 2025-2026 institutional requirements must not be silently presented as rules in force in 2015.